

TASK5-PART A

CASE STUDY-PHISHING ATTACK ON COLLEGE STUDENT

What the Crime Is

Phishing is a cybercrime where attackers impersonate trusted entities (e.g., banks, colleges) via email, SMS, or fake websites to trick victims into revealing sensitive information like passwords, OTPs, or bank details. It exploits trust rather than technical hacks.

How It Typically Happens (Step-by-Step)

1. Bait: Victim receives a urgent message, e.g., "Your VIT Bhopal account is suspended—click to verify."
2. Lure: Link leads to a spoofed site mimicking the real login page.
3. Hook: Victim enters credentials or OTP.
4. Steal: Data is captured and sent to attackers.
5. Exploit: Credentials used for account takeover, fraud, or further scams.

Who Is Usually Targeted

College students are prime targets—tech-savvy but often inexperienced with scams, handling UPI payments, and active on social media/email for assignments/internships.

Real Incident and Consequences

In 2023, Indian student Ravi Kumar (name anonymized) from a Delhi college received a phishing email posing as his bank's alert about a "suspicious UPI transaction." He clicked, entered details, and lost ₹45,000 from his account. Attackers then accessed his linked apps, racking up more fraud (source: Times of India, "Phishing Scam Drains Student's Savings," Oct 2023).

Consequences included financial loss (₹45,000+), credit score damage, emotional stress (anxiety, paranoia), wasted time reporting to cyber cell/bank, and academic disruption (missed classes chasing recovery). Ravi recovered only 60% after weeks of police involvement. Phishing caused 80% of Indian cybercrimes in 2023 per NCRB data, highlighting risks for students balancing digital life and studies.